

SPEAKING FOR ALL
Delhi CM Rekha Gupta (right) with India Today Group's Anjana Om Kashyap

REKHA GUPTA
Chief Minister, Delhi

I believe that courage and decision-making ability have no gender. If you have courage, if you can take decisions, if you can work hard, then the sky is the limit; you can go anywhere

Rekha Gupta does not shut herself in her home; she is on Delhi's streets 24/7, among the people, attending social and religious events, meeting delegations, and conducting public hearings

I cannot spend public money on luxury like them, I cannot waste the public's time. Every moment and every atom of my being is dedicated to the public. I make policies in the public interest, not self-interest

Be it pioneering a scientific breakthrough, winning an Olympic gold, running a government or transforming a business idea into a successful venture, there is no limit to what women can accomplish. To celebrate this 'she power', the India Today Woman Summit 2025, held recently in Delhi, brought together some outstanding women from diverse fields.

Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta set the tone early in her session, 'She's the Boss: Governing the Capital of the World's Largest Democracy', putting across the message that 'courage and decision-making have no gender'. Legal luminary Pallavi S. Shroff made a powerful case for equity, saying that it isn't about being pampered but about being trusted with tough decisions. Senior IAS officers Mugdha Sinha and Anju Sharma spoke of the hidden tax on women in bureaucracy and the emotional toll of over-performance. Wing Commander Vyomika Singh said "the sky became mine because someone believed in me" while Colonel Akriti Sharma highlighted that "women no longer just join—they lead, command and transform".

The summit also amplified voices in science and social change. Poonam Muttreja of the Population Foundation of India called out gender imbalances in reproductive rights; Dr Dhriti Banerjee of the Zoological Survey of India spotlighted the ecological and institutional gaps women leaders continue to bridge. Panels on sports, OTT, entrepreneurship and safety showcased how women aren't just demanding space, they're creating them. The summit made one thing clear: females are not the future, they are already the present. ■

—Shelly Anand